

Delhi Sultanate & Mughal Administration

Iqta, market control, Mansabdari and Zabti — institutions over battle lists.

Portion focus ~34% · Topic: hist-medieval

PYQ themes: Iqta & market reforms · Mansabdari/Zabti · Mughal institutions

Why UPSC asks this

Institutional continuity/change questions dominate medieval polity PYQs.

Sultanate institutional core

Focus on iqta as a revenue–service mechanism, nobility factions, and Alauddin Khalji's market regulations (grain prices, checks on hoarding) as classic Prelims fodder. Tughlaq experiments (token currency, capital shifts) are cautionary “innovation risk” tales — know outcomes at headline level.

Mughal administrative grammar

Mansabdari ranked nobles (zat/sawar); jagirdari linked salary claims to revenue assignments; Zabti measurement–assessment traditions associated with Todar Mal. Akbar's sulh-i-kul and religious discussions at Ibadat Khana appear in culture–polity crossovers. Decline narratives should stress jagir crisis and regional assertiveness rather than only “weak later kings”.

Architecture bridge

Indo-Islamic arches, domes, gardens and city building (Fatehpur Sikri, Shahjahanabad) overlap culture-arch questions — keep dynasty! “monument pairs tight.

Must remember

- Alauddin Khalji — market/price control experiments
- Iqta — revenue–military assignment logic
- Mansabdari zat/sawar; Zabti/Todar Mal bandobast